Complete Setup Guide

Every column · every transaction type · logging CESG grants · ticker format. For the 9 tabs, see your Template Link PDF.

TRANSACTION LOG: ALL COLUMNS

Col	Field	Notes
A	Date	Format yyyy-mm-dd. The transaction date.
B	Year	Calculated from column A. Do not edit.
C	Account	Dropdown: RESP. Required on every row.
D	Type	Dropdown: Contribution · Buy · Sell · CESG · Dividend · DRIP · EAP · Withdrawal
E	Ticker	Canadian ETFs and stocks: TSE: prefix required (TSE:XEQT). Blank for contributions and CESG.
F	Description	Name the child here (“RESP Contribution — Child 1”) so each child’s totals stay clear.
G	Currency	CAD for nearly every RESP holding. USD rows convert to CAD automatically.
H	Shares	Number of units for Buy, Sell and DRIP. Blank otherwise.
I	Price/Share	Price per unit in the original currency.
J	Fees	Brokerage fees, often $0.
K	Amount	Dollar amount for contributions, CESG, distributions, EAPs and withdrawals. Blank for Buy and Sell.
L	FX Rate	Only for USD rows. Fetches the live USD/CAD rate.
M	Amt CAD	LOCKED: (H × I + J) or K, in CAD. Never edit.

TRANSACTION TYPES

Type	Required fields	Notes
Contribution	Date, Account, Type, Amount (K)	Money you put in. Counts toward the $50,000 lifetime limit per child.
Buy	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares, Price	Buying ETF units inside the RESP. Canadian: TSE: prefix.
Sell	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares, Price	ACB recalculates. Gains aren’t taxed while they stay in the RESP.
CESG	Date, Account, Type, Amount (K)	The government grant arriving in the plan. Never log it as a Contribution.
Dividend	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Amount	A cash distribution from an ETF.
DRIP	Date, Account, Type, Ticker, Shares, Price	A distribution reinvested in new units. Adds to your ACB.

Type	Required fields	Notes
EAP	Date, Account, Type, Amount (K)	Educational Assistance Payment to a student in school: grants and growth, taxed in the student's hands.
Withdrawal	Date, Account, Type, Amount (K)	Your own contributions taken back out. Tax-free to you; if the child isn't in school, part of the grant has to be repaid.

LOGGING CESG GRANTS

The grant is paid into your RESP by the federal government (Employment and Social Development Canada) through your RESP provider, usually a few weeks to a few months after you contribute. Log each one as its own row:

Column	What to enter
A — Date	The date the grant landed in your RESP (check your RESP statement)
C — Account	RESP
D — Type	CESG. Use this type, not Contribution, or the grant counts against the $50,000 limit
E — Ticker	Leave blank
F — Description	Name the child, like the sample rows: "CESG Grant — Child 1"
K — Amount	The grant amount, for example $500

GOOGLEFINANCE TICKER FORMAT: IMPORTANT

Canadian ETFs and stocks need the TSE: prefix in column E (TSE:XEQT). Without it, GOOGLEFINANCE can return the wrong price or nothing. US stocks and ETFs use the ticker only, with no prefix.

Stock type	Correct format	Will cause problems	Real examples
Canadian ETFs & stocks (TSX)	Always add the TSE: prefix	XEQT alone can return the wrong price or $0	TSE:XEQT · TSE:VGRO · TSE:XBAL · TSE:XBB
US stocks (NYSE / NASDAQ)	Ticker only, no prefix	NASDAQ:KO can return $0	KO · AAPL · JNJ · MSFT
US ETFs	Ticker only, no prefix	NYSE:SPY can fail	SPY · VTI · QQQ

Most RESPs are best served by Canadian-listed all-in-one ETFs. US dividends paid into an RESP lose 15% to US withholding tax that can't be recovered, so US-listed holdings are rarely worth it here.